Ohio House of Representatives

# Committee Minutes

**COMMITTEE:** Judiciary
**CHAIR:** Jim Thomas
**DATE:** May 13, 2026
**TIME:** **11:00 AM**
**ROOM:** Room 122

Chairman Thomas called the House Judiciary Committee to order at 11:00 a.m.

The roll was called, and a quorum was present. The committee proceeded as a full committee.

The minutes from the previous meeting were approved without objection.

The Chairman called up House Bill 226 for its 3rd hearing.

The Chairman called on Vice Chair Swearingen for a motion.

Vice Chair Swearingen motioned to accept substitute bill with SB 1246-5.

Without objection the motion was accepted.

This concluded the 3rd hearing for House Bill 226.

The Chairman called up House Bill 302 for its 3rd hearing.

The Chairman called on Vice Chair Swearingen for a motion.

Vice Chair Swearingen motioned to accept substitute bill with SB 1488-1.

Without objection the motion was accepted.

This concluded the 3rd hearing for House Bill 302.

The Chairman called up Senate Bill 262 for its 1st hearing.

Senator Blessing was present and offered sponsor testimony. The witness responded to questions from the committee.

This concluded the 1st hearing for Senate Bill 262.

The Chairman called up Senate Bill 61 for its 1st hearing.

Senator Gavarone and Senator Manning were present and offered sponsor testimony. The witnesses responded to questions from the committee.

This concluded the first hearing for Senate Bill 61.

The Chairman called up Senate Bill 174 for its 1st hearing.

The Chairman called on Rep. Williams for a motion.

Rep. Williams motioned to accept substitute bill SB 0493-6

Without objection the motion was accepted.

Senator Gavarone and Senator Hicks-Hudson were present and offered sponsor testimony. The witnesses responded to questions from the committee.

This concluded the 1st hearing for Senate Bill 174.

The Chairman called up House Bill 509 for its 1st hearing.

Rep. Teska was present and offered sponsor testimony. The witness responded to questions from the committee.

This concluded the 1st hearing for House Bill 509.

The Chairman called up House Bill 611 for its 2nd hearing.

The Chairman called on Vice Chair Swearingen for a motion.

Vice Chair Swearingen motioned to accept substitute bill SB 1597-6

Without objection the motion was accepted.

The Chairman called up House Bill 741 for its 1st hearing.

Rep. Swearingen and Rep. LaRe were present and offered sponsor testimony. The witnesses responded to questions from the committee.

This concluded the 1st hearing for House Bill 741.

The Chairman called up House Bill 720 for its 1st hearing.

Rep. Young was present and offered sponsor testimony. The witness responded to questions from the committee.

This concluded the first hearing for House Bill 720.

The Chairman returned and continued with the 2nd hearing for House Bill 611.

Jason Kabbes was present and offered proponent testimony. The witness responded to questions from the committee.

Glen Meert was present and offered proponent testimony. The witness responded to questions from the committee.

This concluded the 2nd hearing of House Bill 611.

The Chairman called up House Bill 528 for its 3rd hearing.

There was no one present to speak to the bill.

This concluded the 3rd hearing of House Bill 528.

Having no further business, the House Judiciary Committee adjourned at 12:46 p.m.

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Jim Thomas, Chair

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Committee Secretary